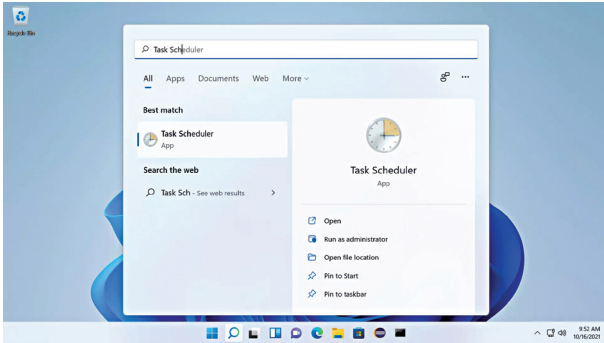


- Weekly (for maintenance)
 - When I log on (for startup workflows)
5. Choose action: Start a program
 6. Select what to start:
 - an app (e.g., Chrome, Teams)
 - a script (.bat, .ps1)
 - or a shortcut
 7. Finish → right-click the task → Run to test.
- Task Scheduler's core model is exactly this: define triggers and execute tasks.



A practical “Indian office laptop” task: open your daily stack at logon

Goal: When you log in, open the apps you *always* open anyway.

- Trigger: At log on
- Action: start your browser, then start Teams, then open your work folder

To do multiple actions, it's cleaner to call one batch file (next section) that launches everything in order.

3) schtasks: Task Scheduler from the command line (for power users)

Windows includes `schtasks.exe` to create, delete, query, run, and end scheduled tasks.

This is useful for admins, power users, and anyone who wants automation that's easy to reproduce.

Step-by-step: See what schtasks can do

1. Open Command Prompt
2. Type `schtasks /?` (help)
3. Note key actions:
 - `schtasks /create` schedules a new task
 - `schtasks /query` lists tasks
 - `schtasks /run` runs now
 - `schtasks /end` stops a running task

Step-by-step: Create a simple scheduled task via schtasks

Microsoft documents syntax and examples for `schtasks /create`.

Use it when you want something repeatable across machines (or you just prefer scripted setup).

Fast Track warning: scheduled tasks are also used by attackers for persistence, so treat random advice/scripts from the internet with suspicion, and only schedule tasks you understand.

4) Batch files: the simplest automation that still feels magical

Batch files are plain text scripts (saved as `.bat` or `.cmd`) that run multiple commands in sequence.

They're perfect for “launch a bunch of apps,” “clean a folder,” “copy files,” “rename things.”

Step-by-step: Create your first batch file (safe, basic)

A common method is:

1. Open Notepad
2. Type commands (one per line)
3. Save as All Files with a `.bat` extension
4. Double-click to run

(If you want the conceptual grounding: batch scripting runs command-line instructions without manual intervention.)



Example 1: “Open my daily work stack”

Create `WorkStart.bat`:

```
@echo off
start "" "C:\Program Files\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe"
start "" "C:\Users\%USERNAME%\AppData\Local\Microsoft\Teams\current\Teams.exe"
```

Why `start ""`? The `start` command prevents the batch file from waiting for each program to finish, and the empty quotes avoid title parsing weirdness – this behavior is widely referenced in Windows batch usage.

Now schedule it: